
TolTEC Raw-Timestream Conditioning

Learn–Apply Filtering, Response,
and Scientific Consequences

Science-Team Rationale

Scientific contract version	v0.1
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Scope of this revision. It defines why RTC operations are selected, what is learned, what becomes immutable, how astronomical modes are changed, and which claims remain available afterward. It does not claim implementation conformity, representation fidelity, observational performance, science qualification, validation, or production readiness.

Executive abstract

Raw-timestream conditioning is a scientific method, not merely a sequence of array operations. Despiking decides which measurements are inconsistent with an intended signal model. Donor replacement redistributes information between detectors or times. Notches and broad-band filters remove temporal modes and alter amplitude, phase, support, and covariance. Decimation changes temporal identity and can alias rejected modes into the retained band. Each choice can therefore change a point-source peak, effective PSF, centroid, extended-source response, calibration transfer, or scientific eligibility without changing a unit label.

SCI-RTC v0.1/r0.3 organizes those choices as **learn–resolve–apply**. Learn uses a declared population and diagnostics to estimate candidate parameters and uncertainty. Resolve combines that evidence with fixed policy and admits one complete immutable RTC plan. Apply executes exactly that plan and does not relearn or retune. An online adaptive filter is a different, time-varying estimator and remains unavailable unless separately authorized. Missing evidence or tolerances are not passes.

Each resolved response is evaluated against the astronomical temporal spectrum induced by the realized scan velocity, projected beam, source class, cadence, and preceding response. A fixed cutoff is not equally safe for all scan speeds or directions. A notch that removes an interference line also removes whatever astronomical response lies in its width. A detector-static `flxscale` cannot restore removed temporal modes, and calibration transfer across different RTC plans requires explicit response accounting or observational evidence.

The output is an atomic bundle of signal, exact plan identity, response, timing convention, support, influence, validity, uncertainty status, and provenance. When a required predicate is unresolved, the affected operation or claim is explicitly unavailable. The formal appendices are the sole normative authority; Sections 1–12 explain their scientific meaning.

Reading rule. Narrative text explains the shared authority but cannot weaken a requirement, choose a missing numerical value, or convert an unavailable state into a pass.

Contents

1	Executive summary and present status	1
2	The learn–resolve–apply paradigm	2
3	Temporal frequencies, scan speed, and astronomical spatial scales	3
4	Despiking and donor replacement	4
5	Notch filtering and learned interference removal	5
6	Low-pass, high-pass, and band-pass filtering	6
7	Filter order, tap count, phase, and temporal registration	7
8	Decimation and alias control	8
9	Masks, edges, state, and non-finite handling	9
10	Calibration, Beammap response, and downstream interpretation	10
11	Covariance, support, and scientific eligibility	11
12	Validation and open owner decisions	12
A	Shared normative authority and notation	13
B	Normative definitions	15
C	Normative equations and identities	17
D	Bounded assumptions and non-goals	21
E	Sequential normative requirements	23
F	Falsifiable predictions and limiting cases	31

1 Executive summary and present status

RTC is the scientific transformation between an admitted aligned detector stream and a conditioned stream whose temporal and detector-mixing response is explicit. Its purpose is not to make every sample finite or every spectrum smooth. Its purpose is to address declared contamination and sampling problems while preserving a quantitatively adequate response for the intended astronomical estimator.

The v0.1 scientific method is learned-then-fixed. Evidence may be learned from a declared population, but application begins only after resolve has produced one complete immutable plan. Online adaptation is a different estimator and is unavailable in this revision. Fixed plans use the same resolve and apply discipline even when no parameter is learned from the observation.

Every operation is interpreted through ten questions: purpose, signal model, operator, design parameters, learning, resolution and application, astronomical consequences, calibration consequences, validation, and unavailable states. Those questions are applied below to despiking, donors, masks, notches, broad-band and general filters, state, boundaries, non-finite handling, and decimation.

The current document is a draft for scientific-owner review. It establishes no production numbers. Open decisions remain open in the ledger; their dependent operations are unavailable. The formal core defines algebraic and semantic authority only. Implementation conformity, representation fidelity, observational performance, science qualification, and production readiness are explicitly unassessed.

Present decision boundary. The owner is being asked to approve the scientific architecture and later resolve the enumerated numerical and policy choices—not to infer those choices from current software or historical practice.

2 The learn–resolve–apply paradigm

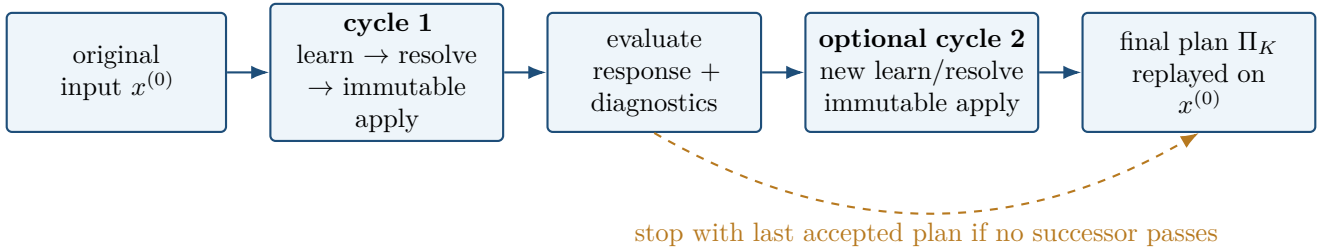
RTC begins with a scientific question: which contaminant or sampling problem must be addressed while retaining adequate astronomical response? The answer is not an operation name. It is a lifecycle that identifies evidence, converts it into a fully specified plan, and applies that plan without hidden adaptation.

Learn. Learn uses a declared population: a separate training interval, a designated part of the same observation, a collection of scans, an observation aggregate, or another named population. It may estimate spike statistics, line centers and widths, filter bands, tap candidates, masks, scan classes, decimation candidates, donor groupings, quality, and uncertainty. Each diagnostic carries estimator, unit, support, selection, and failure state. Learning from the observation later conditioned makes the operator data-dependent. Conditional linear response at fixed state does not eliminate selection bias or parameter-estimation uncertainty.

Resolve. Resolve combines evidence with owner-approved policy. It accepts or rejects every scientific predicate and produces one immutable plan containing sequence, coefficient identity, rates and conventions, order, bands and tolerances, notch state, applicability, masks, donor policy, edges, guards, resets, decimation phase, output timing, expected response/support, uncertainty, and downstream compatibility. Missing evidence or tolerance leaves the dependent plan unresolved.

Apply. Apply consumes exactly one resolved plan. It does not move a notch, change a cutoff or tap count, switch donor policy, change decimation, silently fall back, or refit a parameter. Restart restores the same plan and rejects incompatible inputs. Realized state records what ran without rewriting the request or resolved plan.

V0.1 also permits **bounded iterative notch-plan refinement**. This is an outer finite sequence of complete learn–resolve–apply cycles. Parameters may change only after one apply has finished and a successor learn and resolve have admitted a new complete plan. Each apply remains immutable. This is the v0.1 scientific meaning when “adaptive notch” is used; it is not continuous coefficient tracking and is not the online-adaptive estimator of SCI-RTC-DEF-025.



Cycle k learns from an exact population and an evaluation product, resolves one complete cumulative plan Π_k , and normally applies that plan to the original input $x^{(0)}$. A successor plan names all retained, modified, removed, or rejected notches and every broad-band, state, mask, edge, timing, and decimation choice. It is never merely “add this notch to whatever ran before.” The final production product normally replays Π_K against the original input, avoiding unintended repeated rounding, padding, state transients, duplicate filtering, stale masks, or ambiguous parentage.

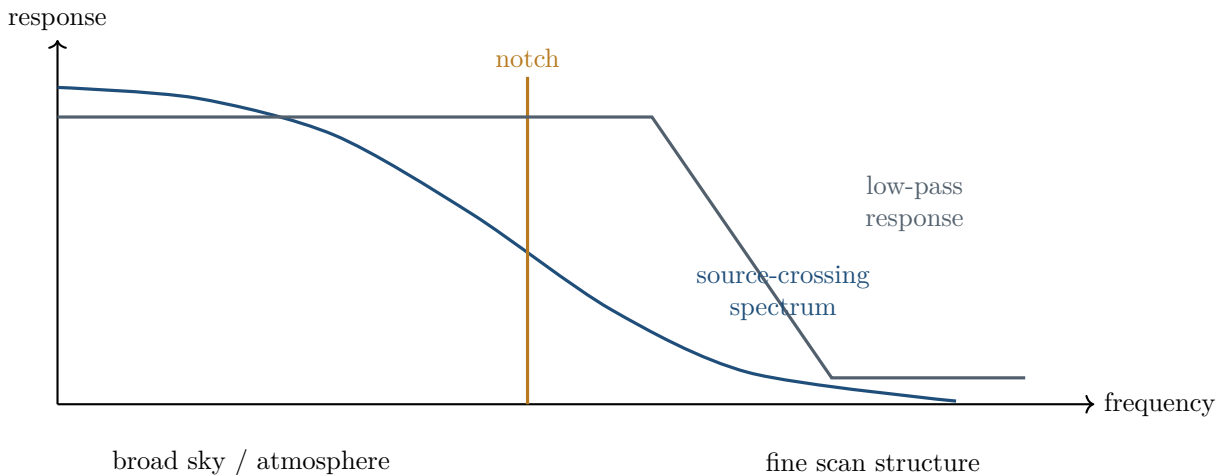
A sequential cascade from the preceding filtered product is a different scientific operator. It is allowed only when selected explicitly and when every immutable intermediate parent, response, state, phase, support, covariance, and uncertainty is retained. Learned-then-fixed and online-adaptive filtering remain different: in the latter, parameters evolve inside one apply pass. V0.1 does not authorize that branch.

Lifecycle test. For each cycle identify the learning and parent products, reproduce every predicate, name the complete cumulative plan, and show that apply did not modify it. Then identify the finite stop cause and the final selected plan. If any link is absent, the refinement claim is unavailable.

3 Temporal frequencies, scan speed, and astronomical spatial scales

The same temporal frequency represents different angular structure in different scans. For a locally Gaussian effective beam with covariance Σ and angular scan velocity $\mathbf{v}$, the characteristic crossing time is equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-023). It uses the beam projected along the actual scan direction, not merely a scalar array FWHM. Source extent, detector and telescope response, prior RTC stages, and cadence further shape the exact source-times-response spectrum.

High frequencies correspond to finer scan-direction structure. Low frequencies contain broad sky structure together with baselines, atmosphere, and slow instrumental behavior. These do not cleanly separate source and contaminant. A Gaussian is not band-limited; extended emission can share low frequencies with atmosphere; a coherent line can overlap a source crossing. The shorthand $f \sim v/\theta$ is pedagogical only.



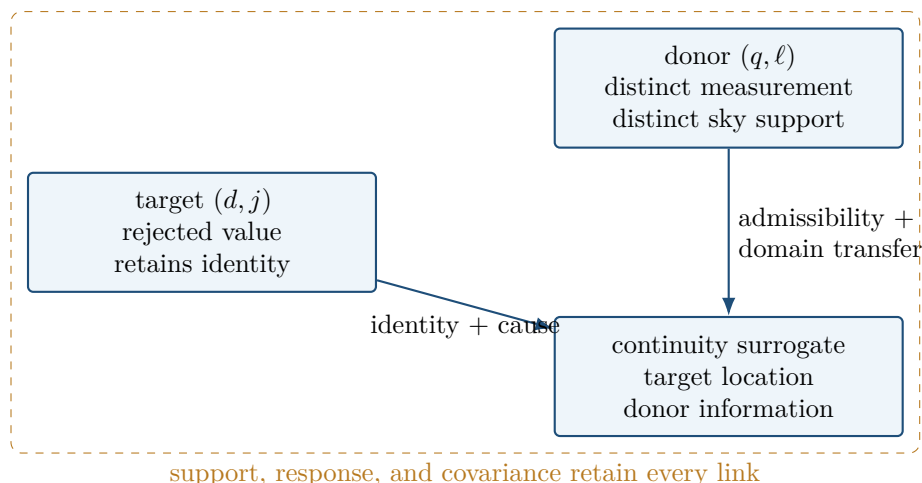
Changing speed moves astronomical modes relative to a fixed cutoff or notch; changing direction changes projected beam width. Every filter is assessed over declared speed, direction, beam, source extent, and source class using the exact realized response. Preserved dimensions or units do not establish preserved peak, PSF, centroid, extended response, or absolute mode.

4 Despiking and donor replacement

Despike purpose and model. Despiking identifies samples inconsistent with an intended detector-plus-sky signal under a stated contaminant model. The statistic, baseline, threshold, support, mask, and false-positive control define the method. Learn may estimate statistics from a declared population; resolve freezes the estimator, threshold, support, boundaries and disposition; apply evaluates them unchanged. A false positive removes sky signal, while a false negative can ring through a long filter. Convergence of an optimizer is not evidence of unbiased retained signal.

A **donor** is an admitted detector-time measurement used to construct a continuity surrogate for a rejected target cell. The output remains located at the target detector and time, but its numerical information comes partly or wholly from the donor. This can prevent a spike, NaN, or gap from contaminating a later filter; it is not automatically reconstruction of the missing astronomical measurement.

Donor and target can differ in focal-plane position, instantaneous sky, beam, atmosphere coupling, baseline, electronic response, loading, noise, and covariance. Numerical convention transfer, donor admissibility, and scientific eligibility are distinct questions. Under $z_i = \phi_i x_i$, equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-002) uses ϕ_q/ϕ_d only for exact compatible occurrences with nonzero target factor. The ratio solves a raw-domain convention problem; it does not prove that both detectors observed the same sky. Beammap donor factors must come from an identified prior APT or other pre-existing authority, never the new **flxscale** being derived from that same Beammap.



Resolve selects topology, time relation, masks, quality, scoring, ties, weights, baseline treatment, reuse and fall-back. Apply cannot change them. Reused donors create correlations and no exposure. V0.1 retains the selected conservative policy: every output transitively influenced by RTC replacement or ALIGN synthesis is scientifically ineligible, while value, cause, response, and support remain visible. Validation injects spikes, invalid samples, factor differences, sky mismatch, donor reuse, source crossings and mask-edge cases, measuring bias, covariance, affected support and data loss.

5 Notch filtering and learned interference removal

A notch suppresses a narrowband coherent disturbance while preserving as much surrounding astronomical information as possible. A line’s physical origin is not inferred from frequency or coherence. The scientific question is what astronomical transfer, phase, support and covariance remain, not only whether the line disappeared.

A resolved notch declares center, rate and frequency convention, width or Q, depth, family and order, poles/zeros where applicable, phase and group delay, state, transient and guard, applicability, learned uncertainty, and drift tolerance. Equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-024) is a generic pole-zero form; the exact realized transfer is authoritative. A too-narrow notch leaves a drifting or finite-width line; a broad notch removes more sky and noise. High Q usually means longer memory. Greater depth can increase numerical sensitivity. Forward/backward use changes magnitude, order, phase and boundaries. Overlapping notches require combined-response analysis.

Learn defines detection, parameter estimation, significance, false-detection control, and the declared detector, network, array, and scan scope. Resolve freezes a common plan and its drift-validity domain. Apply uses it unchanged. A line not found in learn does not prove absence in apply; fitting noise can remove real sky modes. An evolving notch is an online-adaptive estimator with separate update, response, stability and restart authority; it remains unavailable in v0.1.

Successor-cycle assessment. A later learn pass first asks whether the accepted plan had its intended consequences: line attenuation and residual significance, center error or drift, adequate width/depth, ringing, transient, stability, edge loss, phase and group delay, point-source amplitude and centroid, effective PSF, extended-source transfer, covariance, and support. On a declared fixed-state LTI interior, the predicted filtered PSD may be compared with $P_{\text{pred},k}(f) = |H_k(f)|^2 P_0(f)$. That diagnostic is not universal at masks, edges, state transitions, selections, or nonstationary intervals. The spectral hole made by a notch is expected filter response, not new evidence that the original disturbance was absent.

The second question is whether conditioned diagnostics warrant a successor notch. A peak is not sufficient. Resolve compares original, predicted, and conditioned PSDs; cumulative response; line uncertainty; astronomical temporal spectrum; transfer and alias budgets; and detector/network/array/scan/interval consistency. It rejects notch-edge artifacts, ringing, transients, leakage, normalization changes, numerical features, and structure where response is too small for inference. Held-out scans are preferred where practical. Reusing the same data for selection and assessment is labeled observation-internal, data-dependent consistency, not independent validation.

Bounded admission and stopping. A successor is admitted only when its line and parameters are identifiable, it improves the interference metric, and cumulative astronomical amplitude, centroid, PSF, phase, registration, ringing, stability, support, cadence, response, uncertainty, and provenance budgets all pass. Missing evidence or tolerance is not a pass. Rejection leaves the last accepted plan available and preserves the proposal and cause. Iteration stops under an owner-approved finite policy governing cycle count, notch count, removed bandwidth, scientific loss, delay, ringing, edge loss, minimum improvement, plan stability, false-line control, and fallback. Maximum-cycle termination is not convergence. Alternating line sets or unstable parameters are explicitly non-convergent.

Example. Cycle 1 learns a strong coherent line and resolves a notch. After immutable apply, Cycle 2 learns from its diagnostic product and reveals a weaker line. It resolves a complete two-notch plan, which is replayed once against the original input. In the counterexample, a peak at the first notch edge agrees with predicted ringing or response artifact; the candidate is rejected and the one-notch plan remains final. More notches are not automatically better.

`flxscale` cannot restore removed frequencies. Beammap and science observations with different notch plans do not automatically share point-source response, even under the same label. Validation varies center error, drift, width, depth, Q/order, state, direction and overlap, measuring residual line, source transfer, ringing, transient, amplitude, centroid, covariance and edge loss.

6 Low-pass, high-pass, and band-pass filtering

Low-pass. A low-pass suppresses frequencies above a declared band. It can reduce high-frequency noise, prepare for decimation, control aliasing, or define a retained band. It can also attenuate a fast source crossing, broaden or shift the PSF, reduce peak, alter morphology, ring, increase covariance, and reduce usable edge support. Its plan states passband and stopband edges, transition width, ripple, attenuation, phase/delay, family, taps/order, precision, edges and guards.

High-pass. A high-pass can suppress drift or broad atmosphere, but also removes large angular scales, extended flux, absolute or slow sky modes, beam wings and baselines. It can generate negative lobes around compact sources. Any admitted branch needs an explicit recoverable-mode statement.

Band-pass. A band-pass defines a finite scan-dependent temporal and spatial band. Both rejected ends require justification; its combined response, not two cutoff labels, is authoritative.

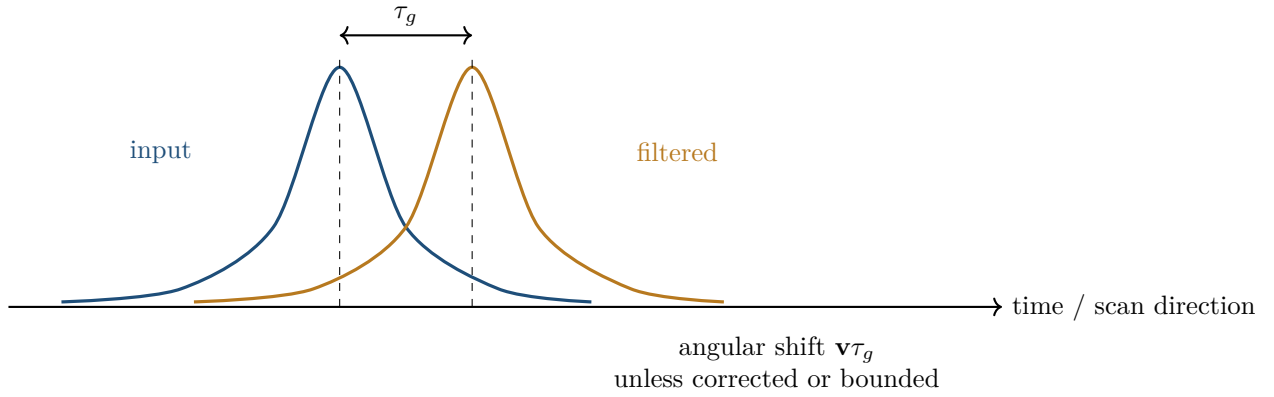
V0.1 admits these classes only through a resolved selected policy and chooses no universal cutoff or family. Where no role is named, the branch is unavailable. Studies vary edges, ripple, attenuation, family, precision, speed, projected beam and source extent, measuring point and extended response, ringing, delay, covariance and usable fraction.

7 Filter order, tap count, phase, and temporal registration

FIR tap count is a scientific design result, not an arbitrary integer. Equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-025) chooses the smallest order satisfying passband, stopband, phase, alias, edge and realizability requirements. A window estimate can initialize a search; only exact coefficients and response close the predicates.

More taps can sharpen transition or attenuation, but increase computation, support, covariance footprint, affected outputs after replacement, and edge loss. They can ring around sources and spikes. Quantization can degrade ripple, attenuation, notch placement and stability. A causal linear-phase FIR has equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-026); forward/backward use can remove ideal interior phase while squaring magnitude, doubling effective order and changing boundaries.

Delay creates scan-direction displacement by equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-027). The output grid time can be simple while response is centered elsewhere. Beammap and Pointing are especially sensitive. Resolve requires zero phase, a shifted time, coordinate correction, response-aware estimator, or a bound showing residual position and PSF effect is negligible.



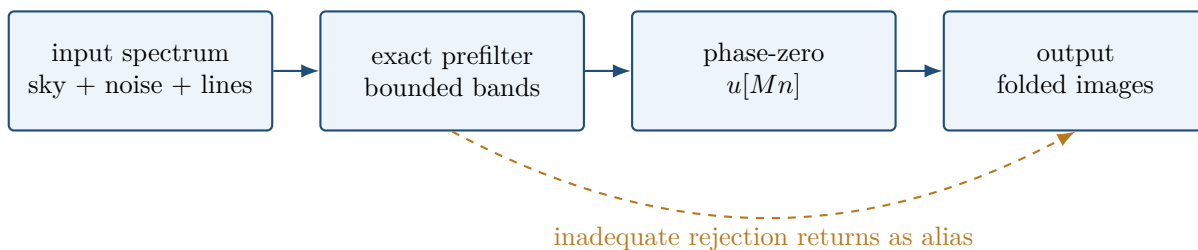
Validation varies taps, family, precision, bands, speed, beam and source class, measuring amplitude, shape, delay, ringing, aliasing, covariance, coordinate registration and usable length. Coefficient algebra alone is not science qualification.

8 Decimation and alias control

V0.1 phase-zero downsampling, equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-011), is point selection $u[Mn]$, not averaging and not anti-alias filtering. It changes software cadence, Nyquist frequency, temporal identity, support, covariance, aliasing, and coordinate registration. The preceding filter determines the rejected-band power that remains to fold.

Equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-014) shows that components separated by integer multiples of output rate can appear at the same output frequency. Before resolving M , the exact prefilter must meet approved tolerances in all folded bands and the declared source domain. A Gaussian is not band-limited, so “safe” means bounded residual transfer and alias, not exact preservation.

Factor choice uses input cadence, exact prefilter, bands, smallest projected beam-crossing time, maximum valid scan speed, source class, required output cadence, delay/coordinate accuracy and consumer compatibility.



Selected grid time t_{Mn} does not erase preceding delay or broad support. Science may require zero phase, shifted time, coordinate correction, response-aware estimation, or a negligibility bound. Tests include on/off-bin tones, varied scan speeds/directions, smallest-beam sources, delay and coordinate checks, aliases, incomplete strides, edges and resets.

9 Masks, edges, state, and non-finite handling

Masks. A source mask protects a coordinate region or changes data used to learn an operation. It requires exact frame, topology, binding, support, validity, geometry, dilation and boundary. It is not acquisition validity or confidence. It can protect real sources while allowing spikes inside the region, and can change normalization, create discontinuities or ringing, and alter state. Learn, resolve and apply state whether the mask is learned, fixed or consumed and what happens if coordinates are unavailable.

FIR boundaries. Complete-context rejection, zero padding, reflection, extension and local renormalization are different operators. A guard removes outputs; it does not prove a residual IIR tail negligible without a criterion. Short and empty scans need explicit dispositions.

IIR state and non-finite values. A plan states initialization, reset/carry boundaries, stability, transient, gaps and cross-scan or cross-observation behavior. A non-finite input can poison state until declared reset or recovery and cannot silently become zero. Learn may estimate state or settling; resolve freezes the convention; apply records actual boundaries and rejects incompatible continuation. Tests place impulses, sources, masks and NaNs at every boundary and split/rejoin streams at state boundaries.

10 Calibration, Beammap response, and downstream interpretation

RTC distinguishes detector-static `flxscale`, sample-dependent target atmosphere correction, detector mixing, single-detector temporal filters, and data-dependent learned or adaptive operators. Their order is not chosen by convenience.

A static factor can commute with a fixed single-detector linear filter on a common support. It does not generally commute with detector mixing. A sample-dependent atmosphere operator does not generally commute even with a single-detector temporal filter. Equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-004) states the burden for an alternative. Unresolved order remains a cross-package owner decision.

Filtering can preserve units while changing peak, PSF, extended response, phase, centroid and covariance. Calibration does not restore removed modes. A Beammap-derived `flxscale` belongs to its complete RTC lineage. A target with a different RTC plan can have a different point-source transfer. Names such as “low-pass” or “notch” are not compatibility: coefficients, rate, phase, state, masks, edges, decimation and response must agree or be accounted for.

Cross-plan calibration needs response calculation, declared renormalization, or observational evidence over the intended source and scan domain. The RTC bundle preserves the plan needed to compare calibrator and target. Without compatibility, the unit may remain meaningful while the photometric or PSF claim is unavailable.

Beammap circularity guard. New <code>flxscale</code> derived from a Beammap cannot be used as donor scaling inside that same Beammap RTC lineage; donor factors come from explicit pre-existing authority.

11 Covariance, support, and scientific eligibility

Output dependence expands through alignment, donors, taps or state, boundaries and sampling. Support—not storage shape—governs information flow. Reused donors correlate targets, overlapping FIRs correlate neighbors, an IIR links to its state boundary, and decimation erases none of those facts.

At fixed state, equations (SCI-RTC-EQ-016a) and (SCI-RTC-EQ-016b) propagate an admitted mean and covariance through the same operator. Data-dependent selection or learned parameters add selection variation and possibly cross terms. Conditioning does not set them to zero. Unknown covariance is unavailable, not diagonal, white or zero.

Eligibility differs from computability. V0.1 marks every output transitively influenced by ALIGN synthesis or RTC replacement ineligible while preserving value, response, cause and support. Downstream roles may add exclusions but cannot erase causes or strengthen unavailable response. Donor studies must measure both bias and resulting data loss; changing this conservative policy requires owner authority.

Response, uncertainty and eligibility accompany signal in the atomic bundle of equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-022). Finite TOD without exact plan, support, response or typed unavailability, influence and validity is incomplete.

12 Validation and open owner decisions

Algebraic fixtures are necessary but not sufficient. Validation varies the scientific design choices and measures the observables they can change.

Study	Variations	Measurements
Notch	center error, drift, width, depth, Q/order, state, direction, overlap	residual line, sky transfer, ringing, transient, amplitude, centroid, covariance, edge loss
FIR/bands	taps, edges, ripple, attenuation, family, precision, speed, beam, source extent	peak/shape, extended transfer, delay, ringing, alias, covariance, usable fraction
Donor	spikes, invalids, factors, sky mismatch, noise, reuse, sources, mask edges	stabilization, bias, covariance, influence extent, scientific data loss
Decimation	on/off-bin tones, speeds/directions, smallest beam, delay, aliases, strides, resets	retained/aliased transfer, timing, coordinate shift, PSF, support, edges

Each study preregisters domain, estimator, tolerance and falsifier. Passing coefficient algebra does not establish science qualification. Observational performance, science impact and production readiness are separate layers.

The owner ledger retains unresolved authority for learning populations and freeze points; despiked/donor/mask policies; notch and broad-band purpose and design; filter families, order/taps, tolerances and precision; edges, state and non-finites; decimation and alias bounds; phase/coordinate registration; CAL/RTC compatibility; diagnostics; uncertainty; and bundle members. Online adaptation remains deferred. An open entry blocks only its named operation or claim and never authorizes a default or silent fallback. Cross-package follow-up routes CAL, BEAM, AST, PTC, VAL, MAP and filtering questions without letting RTC assume their answers.

Success criterion. For every operation, a scientist can explain purpose, learned evidence, resolved numerical choice, immutable application, changed astronomical modes, response and calibration effects, validation evidence, and remaining unavailable claims.

A Shared normative authority and notation

Normative core stamp: SCI-RTC-v0.1/r0.3. The six files in `src/common/` form one authority. Text outside this shared core is explanatory or conformance guidance and cannot alter a definition, equation, assumption, requirement, prediction, unavailable state, or owner decision.

SCI-RTC begins with an admitted aligned primary detector stream and ends with an atomic, role-specific conditioning bundle. ALIGN, AST, SCI-BEAM, and SCI-CAL retain authority for the upstream meanings they produce. PTC, VAL, MAP, BEAM, NOI, MAP-003, FLT, SRC/MODE, and FRUIT retain authority for their downstream science. This contract owns the realized conditioning order and its scientific consequences; it does not infer current software behavior.

The words **shall** and **shall not** identify requirements. **Required unavailable** means that the affected product or claim shall not be reported as complete. **Optional unavailable** is a typed, scientifically inert state. Missing, disabled, automatic, rejected, invalid, failed, unavailable, unsupported, and omitted remain distinct states.

A.1 Indices, sets, and role labels

Symbol	Normative meaning
o	Immutable observation identity.
$d, q \in \mathcal{D}_o$	Exact admitted detector occurrences; d is a target and q may be a donor. A detector index or row number alone is not this identity.
r	Native acquisition row; it is not an aligned or conditioned slot.
$j \in \{0, \dots, N - 1\}$	Ordered aligned input slot on the admitted ALIGN grid.
$n \in \{0, \dots, N_y - 1\}$	Ordered phase-zero RTC output slot.
$\mathcal{R}$	Product role, including Pointing, OOF, Science, Beammap, diagnostic-only, or another separately approved role.
$\delta_{\mathcal{R}}$	Role-domain selector: 0 for an admitted raw role and 1 for a separately CAL-authorized calibrated role.
x_{dj}^A	Admitted aligned primary xs value with declared physical observable, sign, baseline/reference, unit, support, and validity.
z_{dj}	Calibrated value when the role admits an imported CAL operator.
u_{dj}	Role-domain value immediately before the ordered RTC filter chain.
y_{dn}	Conditioned role-domain output at the selected phase-zero slot.
ϕ_d	flxscale for one exact detector occurrence under the declared multiplicative convention and calibration domain.
A_α	Imported, realized ALIGN mapping with state α ; its scientific meaning is not owned by RTC.
C_κ	Imported CAL operator with state κ ; it is the identity for a raw role.
B_ω	Realized despike/replacement operator conditioned on selection state ω .
F_{k,θ_k}	Realized ordered FIR, IIR, notch, or admitted mask-controlled stage k .
$D_{M,0}$	Integer phase-zero point selector of factor $M \geq 1$.
Ω	Complete realized conditioning state, including all upstream bindings and every selected stage, exception, state, edge rule, and output interval.
$\mathcal{L}$	Declared learning population with exact identity, selection, support, masks, exclusions, and compatibility domain.
Λ	Learned evidence and uncertainty produced by declared diagnostics; it is not authorization to apply.
Π	One immutable resolved RTC plan admitted from learned evidence and fixed scientific policy.
$\mathcal{A}_\Pi$	Apply operator that consumes plan Π without changing it.
$k \in \{1, \dots, K\}$	Cycle index and finite owner-bounded terminal cycle for iterative notch-plan refinement.
Π_k	Complete cumulative plan accepted at cycle k ; Π_0 is the admitted initial fixed or identity plan.
$x^{\text{eval},(k)}$	Exploratory evaluation product for cycle k , normally obtained by applying Π_k to original admitted input $x^{(0)}$.
$K_{dn,qj}$	Local detector-time response of one output cell to one acquired input cell.
$\mathcal{S}_{dn}$	Exact transitive input support of output (d, n) , including alignment, donors, filters, state, and selection.
$\mathcal{I}_{dn}$	Cause-preserving transitive influence set for output (d, n) .

A.2 Identity and interval conventions

Observation, Tune, array, network/interface, detector occurrence, selected APT row/binding, native row, aligned slot, scan, science interval, context interval, conditioned output slot, stage, and product identities are non-interchangeable. Array identity is one of **a1100**, **a1400**, and **a2000**; array ID, array index, network ID, detector index, and container position do not substitute for one another. Cross-artifact identity requires an explicit

occurrence- and product-scoped binding. Equal row numbers do not establish identity.

Primary detector timestreams are samples on rows and detectors on columns unless a product explicitly declares another ordered shape. Every interval is half-open. Science windows, physical scans, processing chunks, filter context, output selections, and learned-plan scan sets retain separate identities. Native, aligned, and output indices never silently renumber one another.

Time is seconds on the admitted ALIGN-assigned grid. The approximately 8-ms rate relationships and the $0.5\times$, $2\times$, and $4\times$ family are conditional software-grid facts, not proof of a detector integration event, absolute epoch, or astrometric correction. Coordinate-dependent Pointing, OOF, and Beammap controls use a declared AltAz tangent plane; Science controls use a declared equatorial J2000 TAN relation. RTC performs no implicit frame conversion.

A.3 Logical and availability notation

$\mathbb{I}[\cdot]$ denotes an indicator, $\mathbb{E}$ expectation, Cov covariance, and $\text{supp}(\cdot)$ operator support. The logical symbols $\wedge$, $\vee$, and $\neg$ have their usual meanings. A quantity decorated available is present with its required identity, domain, and validity; a quantity decorated unavailable is explicitly unavailable. Neither zero nor NaN is an availability encoding.

End of notation; shared definitions follow without a change of authority.

B Normative definitions

SCI-RTC-DEF-001 – Admitted aligned stream.

An immutable observation-scoped primary **xs** array whose physical observable, sign, zero/reference, baseline, unit, ordered detector binding, assigned sample grid, cadence, phase, support, origin/synthesis state, validity, scan partition, and mapping lineage are supplied by the responsible upstream authority. Admission does not upgrade unavailable physical event timing.

SCI-RTC-DEF-002 – Product-role signal domain.

The tuple $(\mathcal{R}, Q_{\mathcal{R}}, U_{\mathcal{R}}, s_{\mathcal{R}}, b_{\mathcal{R}}, \mathcal{V}_{\mathcal{R}})$ naming role, physical quantity, unit, sign, reference/baseline, and valid domain. Frozen Beammap uses raw $\Delta f/f$. A separately CAL-authorized role may use calibrated mJy/beam. The domains never substitute silently.

SCI-RTC-DEF-003 – Exact detector occurrence.

An observation-local layered binding containing observation, Tune, network/interface, network-local tone or admitted row slot, selected APT identity/digest, and row association. A transient column number is only a locator.

SCI-RTC-DEF-004 – Imported CAL operator.

An immutable SCI-CAL-selected transformation carrying its detector binding, source and target atmosphere lineage, target unit, factor convention, validity, uncertainty, availability, and provenance. RTC may apply it in an authorized role and owns that order; RTC does not derive, repair, or promote the factor.

SCI-RTC-DEF-005 – Compatible flxscale pair.

Two finite factors ϕ_q and ϕ_d that are valid for the exact donor and target detector occurrences under the same multiplicative calibration convention, quantity domain, reference plane, and applicable support, with $\phi_d \neq 0$. Compatibility is not established by matching row numbers or finite values alone.

SCI-RTC-DEF-006 – Selected conditioning policy.

A versioned, admitted specification of despike detection, donor eligibility, donor scoring and ties, replacement and fallback, source protection, filter stages and order, exact coefficients and normalization, numeric precision, state/reset, boundaries/edges, non-finite handling, sampling mode, phase-zero factor, flags, influence aggregation, diagnostics, and failure behavior. It is selected authority, not an implementation default.

SCI-RTC-DEF-007 – One-way state record.

The ordered record $(\Theta^{\text{req}}, \Theta^{\text{eff}}, \Theta^{\text{obs}}, \Theta^{\text{learned}}, \Theta^{\text{resolved}}, \Theta^{\text{real}})$. Requested state preserves the accepted request; effective state is the admitted typed plan; observation-resolved state binds exact observation facts; learned state records evidence when learning occurs; resolved state is the immutable admitted plan for every fixed or learned operation; and realized state records what ran. A later state never rewrites an earlier state.

SCI-RTC-DEF-008 – Realized conditioning operator.

The chronological composition of every admitted alignment, role-domain, replacement, mask, FIR/IIR/notch, boundary, state, non-finite, and phase-zero sampling action, including all affine state terms and exception intervals. Annotations that affect values, support, influence, or availability are part of the operator.

SCI-RTC-DEF-009 – Phase-zero sampling.

Point selection of the pre-sampling stream at input indices $j = Mn$ for one integer factor $M \geq 1$. It is not an arithmetic mean, block aggregate, or implicit anti-alias filter.

SCI-RTC-DEF-010 – Complete realized response.

An exact local or factorized representation that includes every enabled response-changing stage, detector mixing, mask, state, edge rule, exception, and sampling phase on its declared support. If such a representation is not truthfully available, response state is unavailable; a partial kernel is not complete response.

SCI-RTC-DEF-011 – Direct source cell.

An aligned cell that enters an RTC value before transitive propagation. It may be original, ALIGN-synthesized, or RTC-replaced. Numerical participation does not confer independent scientific exposure.

SCI-RTC-DEF-012 – Transitive influence.

The cause-preserving closure from every original, synthesized, replaced, masked, edge, state, and non-finite source cell through all nonzero realized alignment, donor, filter, state, and sampling dependencies to an output. Influence is broader than the selected point and may cross detector columns.

SCI-RTC-DEF-013 – Scientifically ineligible RTC output.

An output having any transitive influence from an ALIGN-synthesized or RTC-replaced cell. It remains ineligible even when finite and even when the influenced cell is not the phase-zero selected center. Causes and numerical influence remain reportable.

SCI-RTC-DEF-014 – Coordinate-dependent control.

A source mask or response operation that consumes an AST coordinate identity, frame, topology, detector binding, validity, uncertainty where required, and support. Invalid or unavailable coordinates are not outside-source values.

SCI-RTC-DEF-015 – Fixed sampling mode.

A request whose admitted factor, realizable prefilter, rate, phase-zero rule, and downstream compatibility are resolved without learning them from the observation.

SCI-RTC-DEF-016 – Learned sampling mode.

An optional request that evaluates an admitted finite candidate set and resolves one immutable observation-wide cadence/filter plan before apply. Its admission uses the smallest admitted beam, maximum valid in-scan speed, analytical beam-times-realized-filter response, exact phase-zero alias accounting, sampling sufficiency, filter realizability, and downstream compatibility. Noise-aware, per-array, per-scan, heterogeneous-cadence, and continuous adaptation are outside v0.1.

SCI-RTC-DEF-017 – Conditional statistical covariance.

The covariance obtained from an admitted input covariance through a fixed realized operator while holding selection and nuisance state fixed. It is not total uncertainty and does not imply a diagonal, white, stationary, or independent noise model.

SCI-RTC-DEF-018 – Atomic RTC bundle.

One role-specific completion unit containing conditioned TOD; ordered detector/sample/scan/support and parent identity; complete response or typed unavailability; cause-preserving flags and influence; separated validity and eligibility inputs; conditional uncertainty/covariance status; one-way state and provenance; required diagnostics; and completion/failure state. TOD alone is not this bundle.

SCI-RTC-DEF-019 – Scientifically named diagnostic.

A quantity with an explicit estimator, unit, support, selection/mask, validity, uncertainty/availability, and policy role. It is either inert, advisory, or an input to an explicitly selected policy; those roles are not interchangeable.

SCI-RTC-DEF-020 – Claim layer.

One of algebraic contract correctness, implementation conformity, representation fidelity, observational performance, science-impact qualification, or production readiness. Evidence at one layer does not establish another.

SCI-RTC-DEF-021 – Declared learning population.

The exact training interval, designated same-observation interval, scan collection, observation aggregate, or other named population used to infer an RTC quantity, including identity, support, selection, masks, exclusions, signal role, compatibility domain, and completeness. A population is not defined by whatever samples happen to be available during execution.

SCI-RTC-DEF-022 – Learned evidence.

The output of named diagnostics applied to a declared learning population, including candidate parameters, estimator, unit and convention, support, quality, uncertainty, validity, and failure state. Learned evidence proposes or constrains a plan; it does not authorize apply.

SCI-RTC-DEF-023 – Resolved RTC plan.

One immutable observation- and role-bound specification admitted only after all required scientific predicates pass. It contains operation sequence, family, exact coefficients or identity, rates and conventions, order/taps, bands and tolerances, notch state, applicability, masks, donor policy, edges, guards, resets, decimation and timing, expected response/support, uncertainty, validity, and downstream compatibility.

SCI-RTC-DEF-024 – Apply state.

Execution of exactly one resolved plan on compatible admitted input. Apply records actual intervals, exceptions, resets, outputs, and completion but does not relearn, retune, change policy, or rewrite the resolved plan.

SCI-RTC-DEF-025 – Online-adaptive estimator.

A separate time-varying, data-dependent estimator whose coefficients or other operator parameters evolve during apply under a declared update rule. Its learning support, stability, response, uncertainty, guard, reset, and restart semantics are not those of learned-then-fixed filtering. It is unavailable in v0.1 absent successor authority.

SCI-RTC-DEF-026 – Scientific filter design specification.

The physical purpose, source/contaminant model, admitted scan/beam/source domain, pass/transition/stop or notch constraints, phase and registration, alias bound, support/guard, numeric precision, realizability, validation, and failure criteria that justify a filter family and its numerical parameters. An operation label or coefficient array alone is not this specification.

SCI-RTC-DEF-027 – Bounded iterative notch-plan refinement.

A finite owner-bounded outer sequence of learn–resolve–apply cycles in which each cycle learns from a declared population and identified parent product, resolves one complete immutable cumulative plan, and applies that plan without within-cycle parameter change. Parameters may change only between completed cycles. This is not the online-adaptive estimator of SCI-RTC-DEF-025.

SCI-RTC-DEF-028 – Complete cumulative successor plan.

The full plan proposed or accepted for cycle k , containing every retained, modified, removed, and rejected notch disposition; every broad-band stage; exact order, coefficients, precision, state, masks, edges, guards, intervals, decimation, timing, cumulative response/support, uncertainty, validity, and downstream compatibility. “Add this notch to the prior output” is not a complete successor plan.

SCI-RTC-DEF-029 – Final accepted plan and termination disposition.

The last complete plan whose admission predicates passed, together with one typed finite stop cause. No-successor, residual-satisfied, stable-plan, budget/stability/support/compatibility rejection, insufficient evidence, maximum-cycle, oscillating-plan, nonconvergent-parameter, and owner-cancelled states remain distinct. Maximum-cycle termination is not convergence.

C Normative equations and identities

The equations in this section are the sole displayed mathematical authority of both views. They describe an implementation-independent, state-conditioned operator. They neither select numerical policy nor assert implementation conformity.

C.1 Role domain and donor transfer

For an exact detector occurrence i under the admitted multiplicative raw-to-calibrated convention,

$$z_i = \phi_i x_i, \quad \phi_i = \text{flxscale}_i. \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-001})$$

Equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-001) does not assign a role to legacy **responsivity**. When q is a raw donor and d is a raw target, the unique multiplicative transfer that represents donor-calibrated amplitude in the target raw convention is

$$x_{d \leftarrow q}^R = a_{d \leftarrow q} x_q, \quad a_{d \leftarrow q} = \frac{\phi_q}{\phi_d}, \quad \phi_d x_{d \leftarrow q}^R = \phi_q x_q. \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-002})$$

This equation is defined only for a compatible **flxscale** pair as defined above. Otherwise this transfer is unavailable. An additive calibration convention, a different unit/reference domain, or an alternative donor authority requires its own complete affine equivalence and is not silently folded into equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-002).

Let the role-domain operator be

$$C_{\mathcal{R}} = \begin{cases} I, & \delta_{\mathcal{R}} = 0 \quad (\text{admitted raw role}), \\ C_{\kappa}, & \delta_{\mathcal{R}} = 1 \quad (\text{CAL-authorized role}). \end{cases} \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-003})$$

For a CAL-authorized role, calibration precedes cross-detector replacement. For a raw role, $C_{\mathcal{R}} = I$ and an admitted raw donor transfer may use equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-002). Reversing calibration and replacement is equivalent only if, for the complete admitted affine operators on the exact support,

$$B_{\omega}^{(z)} C_{\kappa} = C_{\kappa} B_{\omega}^{(x)}, \quad \mathbf{b}_{\omega}^{(z)} = C_{\kappa} \mathbf{b}_{\omega}^{(x)} + \mathbf{c}_{\kappa} - B_{\omega}^{(z)} \mathbf{c}_{\kappa}, \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-004})$$

with unit, factor direction, additive offset, response, uncertainty, identity, validity, and domain equivalence all proved. Equality of numerical values in one fixture is insufficient.

C.2 Realized conditioning operator

Conditioned on complete realized state Ω , the ordered role-specific operator is

$$\boxed{\mathbf{y}_{\mathcal{R}} = D_{M,0} F_{K,\theta_K} \cdots F_{1,\theta_1} B_{\omega,\mathcal{R}} [C_{\mathcal{R}} (A_{\alpha} \mathbf{x}^{\text{acq}} + \mathbf{a}_{\alpha}) + \mathbf{c}_{\mathcal{R}}] + \mathbf{b}_{\Omega}} \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-005})$$

Chronological order is read from right to left. The affine terms include only declared calibration, replacement, filter-state, boundary, or other authorized contributions. Masks, coefficients, finite handling, context, exceptions, and state are components of Ω , not annotations outside the operator. Conditional on them,

$$\mathbf{y}_{\mathcal{R}} = L_{\Omega} \mathbf{x}^{\text{acq}} + \mathbf{b}'_{\Omega}, \quad L_{\Omega} = D_{M,0} F_K \cdots F_1 B_{\omega,\mathcal{R}} C_{\mathcal{R}} A_{\alpha}. \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-006})$$

This is a conditional affine identity, not an unconditional linear, stationary, unbiased, or Gaussian claim.

A realized replacement at target cell (d, j) may be written

$$u_{dj}^R = (1 - p_{dj}) u_{dj} + p_{dj} \left[\sum_{(q,\ell) \in \mathcal{Q}_{dj}} w_{dj,q\ell} a_{d \leftarrow q,j\ell} u_{q\ell} + \beta_{dj} \right], \quad \sum_{q,\ell} w_{dj,q\ell} = 1 \text{ when normalization is claimed.} \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-007})$$

The scale a is domain-qualified: equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-002) is the authorized raw **flxscale** route, while a calibrated-domain transfer or any separately authorized route carries its own identity and validity.

For a time-invariant FIR stage,

$$v_{d,j} = \sum_{\ell \in \mathcal{L}_k} h_{d,\ell}^{(k)} u_{d,j-\ell}, \quad H_d^{(k)}(e^{i\omega}) = \sum_{\ell \in \mathcal{L}_k} h_{d,\ell}^{(k)} e^{-i\omega\ell}, \quad H_d^{(k)}(1) = \sum_{\ell} h_{d,\ell}^{(k)}. \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-008})$$

For a causal IIR or notch stage, a state-complete form is

$$\mathbf{s}_{j+1} = A_k \mathbf{s}_j + B_k u_j, \quad v_j = C_k \mathbf{s}_j + D_k u_j, \quad \mathbf{s}_{j_0} = \mathbf{s}_{0,k}. \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-009})$$

An exactly equivalent recurrence is admissible only with its coefficient convention, precision, state, and boundary identity. A causal-stability claim requires every realized pole strictly inside the unit circle.

One possible selected mask operator is normalized masked FIR convolution,

$$v_j = \frac{\sum_{\ell} h_{\ell} m_{j-\ell} u_{j-\ell}}{\sum_{\ell} h_{\ell} m_{j-\ell}}, \quad \left| \sum_{\ell} h_{\ell} m_{j-\ell} \right| > \epsilon_m, \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-010})$$

but equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-010) is not a selected default. Segmenting, zero filling, restoring a mask after filtering, holding state, and renormalizing are distinct operators.

C.3 Phase-zero sampling and response

For a coherent pre-sampling segment of length N , v0.1 selects only

$$y_{d,n} = u_{d,Mn}, \quad 0 \leq Mn < N, \quad f_{\text{out}} = \frac{f_{\text{in}}}{M}, \quad N_y = \begin{cases} 0, & N = 0, \\ 1 + \left\lfloor \frac{N-1}{M} \right\rfloor, & N > 0. \end{cases} \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-011})$$

The representative assigned-grid time is the selected point time $t_n^{\text{out}} = t_{Mn}$; the scientific support is nevertheless the complete transitive support $\mathcal{S}_{dn}$ of all preceding stages. A selected edge/output policy may reject candidate points, but shall not relabel a different phase or silently change equation ([SCI-RTC-EQ-011](#)).

For output (d, n) and acquired input (q, j) , the exact local response is

$$K_{dn,qj} = \frac{\partial y_{dn}}{\partial x_{qj}^{\text{acq}}} \quad \text{at fixed realized state } \Omega. \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-012})$$

At a selection boundary the derivative may be discontinuous or undefined; that state shall be represented rather than replaced by an LTI claim.

In the fixed, detector-separable, translation-invariant, single-rate interior case only,

$$H_d^{\text{comb}}(e^{i\omega}) = \prod_{k=1}^K H_d^{(k)}(e^{i\omega}), \quad \tau_g(\omega) = -\Delta t \frac{d}{d\omega} \text{unwrap}[\arg H_d^{\text{comb}}(e^{i\omega})]. \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-013})$$

Amplitude is $|H|$, power response is $|H|^2$, and phase is $\arg H$ under the recorded Fourier convention. Group delay is unavailable at response zeros unless a bounded convention is supplied.

For an LTI prefilter followed by phase-zero selection, the exact multirate identity is

$$Y(e^{i\Omega_o}) = \frac{1}{M} \sum_{r=0}^{M-1} H(e^{i(\Omega_o+2\pi r)/M}) X(e^{i(\Omega_o+2\pi r)/M}), \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-014})$$

under the declared Fourier/sign convention. Every folded image contributes; point selection itself is not anti-alias filtering.

For an FIR output, direct support starts with

$$\mathcal{S}_{dn}^{(1)} = \{Mn - \ell : \ell \in \mathcal{L}\}, \quad \mathcal{S}_{dn} = \text{closure}_{A,B,F,\text{state}}(\mathcal{S}_{dn}^{(1)}). \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-015})$$

IIR support extends to the declared state/reset or context boundary and may be mathematically infinite. Any finite guard is an approximation with a stated residual-tail criterion.

C.4 Moments, influence, and learned-plan selection

For admitted input mean $\boldsymbol{\mu}_x$ and full covariance Σ_x , conditional on fixed Ω independent of the modeled random noise,

$$\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{y} \mid \Omega] = L_\Omega \boldsymbol{\mu}_x + \mathbf{b}'_\Omega, \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-016a})$$

$$\Sigma_{y|\Omega}^{\text{stat}} = L_\Omega \Sigma_x L_\Omega^\top. \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-016b})$$

If selectors depend on the random data, unconditional covariance obeys

$$\text{Cov}(\mathbf{y}) = \mathbb{E}_\Omega[\text{Cov}(\mathbf{y} \mid \Omega)] + \text{Cov}_\Omega(\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{y} \mid \Omega]). \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-017})$$

The second term is not zero by default. With named nuisance parameters $\boldsymbol{\eta}$ and an adequate local linearization,

$$\Sigma_y^{\text{sys}} \approx J_\eta \Sigma_\eta J_\eta^\top, \quad J_\eta = \left. \frac{\partial \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{y} \mid \Omega, \boldsymbol{\eta}]}{\partial \boldsymbol{\eta}} \right|_{\boldsymbol{\eta}_0}, \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-018})$$

and a total-covariance claim requires every applicable component and cross term:

$$\Sigma_y^{\text{total}} = \Sigma_y^{\text{stat}} + \Sigma_y^{\text{sys}} + \Sigma_y^{\text{selection}} + \Sigma_y^{\text{model}} + \Sigma_y^{\text{cross}}. \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-019})$$

Unknown components are unavailable, not zero.

Define cause-preserving influence and the v0.1 ineligibility rule by

$$\mathcal{I}_{dn} = \text{closure}_{K, \text{generative links}} \{\text{typed source causes on } \mathcal{S}_{dn}\}, \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-020a})$$

$$E_{dn}^{\text{RTC}} = V_d^{\text{det}} \wedge V_{dn}^{\text{num}} \wedge V_{dn}^{\text{support}} \wedge V_{dn}^{\text{response}} \wedge \neg \mathbb{I}[\text{ALIGN_synth} \in \mathcal{I}_{dn}] \wedge \neg \mathbb{I}[\text{RTC_replace} \in \mathcal{I}_{dn}]. \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-020b})$$

Consumer-specific coordinate or policy predicates may further restrict eligibility; they may not remove either transitive-influence exclusion.

For learned mode, let $\mathcal{M}$ be the admitted finite integer candidate set and $\mathcal{F}(M)$ the conjunction of all owner-resolved astronomical transfer, exact phase-zero alias, sampling, realized-filter realizability, and downstream-compatibility constraints, evaluated with the smallest admitted beam and maximum valid in-scan speed. Then

$$\mathcal{M}_{\text{safe}} = \{M \in \mathcal{M} : \mathcal{F}(M) = \text{true}\}, \quad M_{\star} = \max \mathcal{M}_{\text{safe}}. \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-021})$$

Equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-021) is defined only after every numerical tolerance, support rule, fallback, and compatibility predicate named in the owner ledger is resolved. Percentile speed is diagnostic, not safety authority.

Finally, the atomic product is

$$\mathcal{O}_{\text{RTC}, \mathcal{R}} = (\mathbf{y}, \mathcal{J}, \mathcal{K}, \mathcal{S}, \mathcal{I}, \mathcal{F}, \mathcal{V}, \mathcal{U}, \mathcal{P}, \mathcal{D}, \mathcal{C}), \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-022})$$

where $\mathcal{J}$ is ordered identity, $\mathcal{K}$ complete response status, $\mathcal{S}$ support, $\mathcal{I}$ influence, $\mathcal{F}$ typed flags/causes, $\mathcal{V}$ separated validity and eligibility inputs, $\mathcal{U}$ uncertainty/covariance availability, $\mathcal{P}$ one-way state/provenance, $\mathcal{D}$ diagnostics, and $\mathcal{C}$ atomic completion or required-output failure state.

C.5 Scientific design and learn–resolve–apply identities

For a locally Gaussian effective beam with angular covariance Σ and angular scan-velocity vector $\mathbf{v}$, the projected source-crossing time scale is

$$\sigma_t = (\mathbf{v}^T \Sigma^{-1} \mathbf{v})^{-1/2}. \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-023})$$

Equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-023) is a local Gaussian diagnostic. Scientific admission shall use the exact source-times-realized-response model over the declared beam, scan, source-class, and cadence domain.

A generic realized notch may be represented, where applicable, by

$$H_{\text{notch}}(z) = g \frac{\prod_{a=1}^{N_z} (1 - z_a z^{-1})}{\prod_{b=1}^{N_p} (1 - p_b z^{-1})}, \quad |p_b| < 1 \text{ for a causal-stability claim.} \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-024})$$

This form imposes no universal biquad. Exact realized coefficients, sample rate, frequency convention, phase/direction, state, edges, and precision are part of the response.

For an admitted FIR design family H_N , a selected order shall follow a declared constrained problem of the form

$$N_{\star} = \min_N \left\{ N : \begin{array}{l} \sup_{f \in \mathcal{P}} |H_N(f) - H_{\text{target}}(f)| \leq \epsilon_{\mathcal{P}}, \\ \sup_{f \in \mathcal{S}} |H_N(f)| \leq \epsilon_{\mathcal{S}}, \\ \text{phase/delay, alias, edge/guard, precision, and realizability predicates pass} \end{array} \right\}. \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-025})$$

The sets, metrics, tolerances, equality conventions, and family are owner-resolved; an approximate order formula is not universal authority.

For a causal linear-phase FIR with N taps at rate f_{samp} , its nominal interior group delay is

$$\tau_g = \frac{N - 1}{2f_{\text{samp}}}. \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-026})$$

Where a temporal response has effective delay τ during a locally uniform scan, the corresponding scan-direction angular displacement is

$$\Delta\theta = \mathbf{v} \tau. \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-027})$$

For every learned RTC operation, the lifecycle is

$$\Lambda = \text{Learn}(\mathcal{L}; \Theta^{\text{eff}}), \quad \Pi = \text{Resolve}(\Lambda, \Theta^{\text{policy}}), \quad \mathbf{y} = \mathcal{A}_{\Pi}(\mathbf{x}), \quad \frac{\partial \Pi}{\partial j} = 0 \text{ during apply.} \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-028})$$

The final equality denotes plan immutability over apply slots; it is not an assumption that the realized operator is stationary at masks, edges, state boundaries, or other declared exceptions.

For bounded iterative notch-plan refinement with original admitted input $x^{(0)}$, initial fixed or identity plan Π_0 , and finite K ,

$$\begin{aligned} \Lambda_k &= \text{Learn}(\mathcal{L}_k, x^{\text{eval},(k-1)}, \Pi_{k-1}), \\ \Pi_k &= \text{Resolve}(\Lambda_k, \Pi_{k-1}, \Theta^{\text{policy}}), \\ x^{\text{eval},(k)} &= \mathcal{A}_{\Pi_k}(x^{(0)}), \quad x^{\text{final}} = \mathcal{A}_{\Pi_K}(x^{(0)}), \\ \frac{\partial \Pi_k}{\partial j} &= 0 \quad \text{during the apply slots of cycle } k, \quad 1 \leq k \leq K < \infty. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{SCI-RTC-EQ-029})$$

Equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-029) states the default original-input replay rule. A sequential cascade from $x^{\text{eval},(k-1)}$ requires separate explicit operator authority and complete propagation of every intermediate parent, response, state, phase, edge, support, covariance, and uncertainty.

D Bounded assumptions and non-goals

SCI-RTC-ASM-001 – Capability.

V0.1 treats Stokes-I primary **xs**. Enabled polarimetry and measured R-channel execution are excluded until separately approved.

SCI-RTC-ASM-002 – Aligned-grid boundary.

The input grid, cadence, phase, mapping, gaps, synthesis/origin state, support, and scan partition are admitted ALIGN facts. Physical event timing, absolute timing accuracy, and a producer epoch may remain unavailable.

SCI-RTC-ASM-003 – Coordinate boundary.

Coordinate-dependent operations assume an admitted AST identity, frame, topology, detector binding, support, validity, and uncertainty where required. The absence of such authority does not license inference or clamping.

SCI-RTC-ASM-004 – Calibration boundary.

Calibration-factor production, atmosphere lineage, beam meaning, uncertainty, and promotion belong to SCI-BEAM/SCI-CAL. RTC conditions on an admitted operator only for a role that authorizes it.

SCI-RTC-ASM-005 – Selected-policy boundary.

Despite, donor, mask, FIR, IIR, notch, state, edge, non-finite, recovery, sampling, diagnostic, and failure choices are selected versioned policies. No current default or numerical threshold is promoted to a universal scientific constant by this contract.

SCI-RTC-ASM-006 – Conditional linearity.

Linear response and covariance identities condition on fixed realized selection and state. Data-derived selectors make the unconditional operation generally nonlinear and nonstationary.

SCI-RTC-ASM-007 – Statistical input.

Moments or covariance are claimed only from a supplied statistical model with declared correlation and limitations. Absence does not imply diagonal, white, stationary, independent, or zero covariance.

SCI-RTC-ASM-008 – Learned-mode scope.

Every learned-then-fixed RTC operation uses one declared learning population, one resolved immutable plan, and one explicit compatibility domain. The first learned sampling scope produces one common observation plan. Per-array, per-scan, heterogeneous-cadence, noise-aware, and continuously adaptive sampling execution are successor scopes. Bounded iterative notch-plan refinement is admitted only as a finite outer sequence of complete immutable learned-then-fixed cycles; it does not admit parameter evolution within one apply pass.

SCI-RTC-ASM-009 – Analytical authority.

Exact analytical source-times-realized-filter transfer and phase-zero alias accounting define learned-plan admission. Deterministic vectors may falsify a realization, while source injections and observational studies are required for separately claimed performance or science-impact evidence.

SCI-RTC-ASM-010 – Compact representation.

Dense observation-sized response, covariance, or per-sample provenance is not required when a factorized, sparse, interval-based, or generative representation exactly reconstructs the operator, support, causes, and exceptions.

SCI-RTC-ASM-011 – Downstream authority.

RTC supplies causal inputs but does not own PTC cleaning/weights, VAL eligibility policy, MAP estimation, BEAM inference, empirical NOI products, MAP-003 response tracing, map filtering, source fitting, or fruit-loop recurrence.

SCI-RTC-ASM-012 – Claim separation.

The contract is an algebraic and semantic authority only. It contains no claim that a present implementation conforms, that a representation is faithful, that observational performance is adequate, or that a mode is ready for production.

D.1 Explicit non-goals

This revision does not derive ALIGN timing, AST coordinates, SCI-BEAM or SCI-CAL calibration, PTC, VAL, MAP, or FLT estimators, source fitting, or recurrence; authorize absolute-timing or astrometric corrections; redesign mature despiking/FIR/IIR/notch numerics; choose universal numerical thresholds; authorize online adaptation; activate polarimetry or measured R; prescribe source classes, files, storage schemas, or product names; authorize per-array/per-scan cadence; inspect implementation; perform validation or reductions; or assert production status.

E Sequential normative requirements

The following identifiers are stable within v0.1/r0.3. Conformance is requirement-by-requirement; satisfying a neighboring requirement does not waive another one.

Area	ID	Normative statement
Boundary	SCI-RTC-REQ-001	RTC shall admit only an aligned primary xs stream whose signal meaning, ordered identity, assigned grid, support, origin/synthesis state, and validity are declared.
Boundary	SCI-RTC-REQ-002	Every requested product role shall declare physical quantity, unit, sign, reference/baseline, valid domain, and required consumers; no channel or role shall inherit another role's meaning.
Boundary	SCI-RTC-REQ-003	The primary standardized Beammap detector signal shall remain raw $\Delta f/f$ and shall not be silently replaced by a calibrated timestream or map.
Boundary	SCI-RTC-REQ-004	A calibrated mJy/beam domain shall be produced only for a separately CAL-authorized role with admitted factor identity, convention, atmosphere lineage, detector binding, validity, uncertainty availability, and provenance.
Boundary	SCI-RTC-REQ-005	RTC shall own the exact ordered application and response consequence of an imported CAL operator but shall not derive, repair, promote, or reinterpret its factor science.
Identity	SCI-RTC-REQ-006	Observation, Tune, array, network/interface, detector occurrence, APT binding, native row, aligned slot, scan, science interval, context interval, output slot, stage, and product identity shall remain distinct and immutable.
Identity	SCI-RTC-REQ-007	The ordered detector and sample shapes, index bases, native-to-aligned mapping, aligned-to-output map, scan membership, and memory order shall be explicit; indices shall not serve as cross-artifact detector identity.
Identity	SCI-RTC-REQ-008	RTC shall preserve the admitted ALIGN cadence, phase, rate, gaps, support, and synthesis/origin state without claiming physical integration-event timing or absolute epoch authority.
Identity	SCI-RTC-REQ-009	A coordinate-dependent operation shall consume the exact AST identity, frame, topology, detector binding, support, and validity required by its product role, with no implicit frame conversion.
State	SCI-RTC-REQ-010	Requested, effective, observation-resolved, learned/resolved when applicable, and realized state shall be recorded separately in one-way order; later state shall not overwrite the accepted request.
State	SCI-RTC-REQ-011	Outer, inner, full, mini, diagnostic, simulated, processed, and any other produced stage roles shall have distinct immutable identities and explicit parent/processing links without requiring duplicate computation.
Policy	SCI-RTC-REQ-012	Every desprike, donor, replacement, mask, filter, state, edge, non-finite, recovery, sampling, flag, diagnostic, and fallback action shall be governed by an admitted versioned selected policy rather than an undocumented default.
Order	SCI-RTC-REQ-013	For a CAL-authorized role, calibration shall precede cross-detector replacement unless complete affine equivalence in equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-004) is proved for the exact unit, factor, offset, response, uncertainty, identity, validity, and domain.

Area	ID	Normative statement
Donor	SCI-RTC-REQ-014	A raw donor q to raw target d using the multiplicative convention $z_i = \phi_i x_i$ shall use ϕ_q/ϕ_d only when both flxscale factors are valid for the exact occurrences under the same compatible convention/domain and $\phi_d \neq 0$.
Donor	SCI-RTC-REQ-015	The raw donor route in REQ-014 shall use flxscale and shall neither require nor restore a scientific role for legacy responsivity .
Donor	SCI-RTC-REQ-016	When REQ-014 is not available, replacement shall fail under that route unless a separate donor-to-target authority declares direction, quantity/unit domain, support, uncertainty, validity, and provenance.
Donor	SCI-RTC-REQ-017	The despite detector, target indicator, candidate eligibility, topology, score, tie rule, donor weights, time relation, source-mask/flag use, fallback, and every realized donor link shall be reconstructible.
Donor	SCI-RTC-REQ-018	A replaced target shall retain target identity, link every donor and factor, preserve the replacement cause, and expose correlations from reused or shared donors; finiteness shall not create independent exposure.
Influence	SCI-RTC-REQ-019	Every output transitively influenced by an ALIGN-synthesized cell shall be scientifically ineligible while preserving its numerical effect, typed cause, and support.
Influence	SCI-RTC-REQ-020	Every output transitively influenced by an RTC-replaced cell shall be scientifically ineligible while preserving its numerical effect, typed cause, donor linkage, and support.
Filter	SCI-RTC-REQ-021	Every enabled response-changing stage shall record chronological order, exact full-precision coefficients or exact digest, coefficient convention, normalization, numeric precision, rate, direction, state, context, mask, edge, non-finite policy, and exceptions once per coherent segment.
Filter	SCI-RTC-REQ-022	An FIR claim shall expose exact impulse support, DC gain, phase convention, and normalization; a label such as “normalized” shall not substitute for the coefficient sum or response.
Filter	SCI-RTC-REQ-023	An IIR or notch claim shall expose an exact recurrence or state-space equivalent, realized poles/zeros where applicable, initial/final state, reset/carry boundary, transient/guard rule, precision, and stability status.
Mask	SCI-RTC-REQ-024	A processing mask shall be represented as an operator control, including geometry or selection, boundary convention, dilation, denominator/segment behavior, and state interaction; it shall not be treated as acquisition validity or confidence.
Mask	SCI-RTC-REQ-025	Invalid, unavailable, wrong-frame, out-of-domain, or ambiguously bound coordinates shall not become outside-source samples and shall fail the affected required coordinate operation.
Finite	SCI-RTC-REQ-026	A non-finite required sample, factor, coefficient, coordinate, or filter state shall be rejected, marked unavailable over its exact transitive influence, or handled by an explicitly authorized prior replacement/recovery rule; it shall not be silently coerced to zero.
Edge	SCI-RTC-REQ-027	Boundary extension, incomplete context, filter guards, IIR recovery, short/empty scans, and output selection shall be explicit; an edge or incomplete-state cell shall not be labeled an ordinary interior sample.

Area	ID	Normative statement
Sampling	SCI-RTC-REQ-028	V0.1 downsampling shall use only phase-zero point selection $y[n] = u[Mn]$; arithmetic-mean and other block-aggregate downsampling are excluded.
Sampling	SCI-RTC-REQ-029	Each coherent segment shall record M , zero phase, input/output rates and grids, the cardinality of equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-011), selected-point representative time, full transitive support, edge disposition, and flag/influence aggregation.
Sampling	SCI-RTC-REQ-030	Any alias-free or bounded-alias claim shall include the exact realized prefilter and all folded bands of equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-014), with a declared input band, metric, bound, and unavailable state; point selection alone shall not be called anti-alias filtering.
Sampling	SCI-RTC-REQ-031	Fixed mode shall resolve an admitted factor/filter/rate/compatibility plan before application and record it independently of realized output.
Learned	SCI-RTC-REQ-032	Every learned RTC operation shall preserve distinct requested, effective, observation-resolved, learned-evidence, resolved-plan, and applied states and shall not advertise a plan before admitted evidence and numeric policy are complete.
Learned	SCI-RTC-REQ-033	Learned resolution shall choose the largest admitted integer factor only after astronomical-transfer, exact phase-zero alias, sampling, filter-realizability, and downstream-compatibility constraints all pass using the smallest admitted beam and maximum valid in-scan speed.
Learned	SCI-RTC-REQ-034	The first learned applied scope shall use one common immutable observation cadence and filter across arrays and scans; percentile speed shall remain diagnostic rather than safety authority.
Learned	SCI-RTC-REQ-035	Apply shall consume exactly one immutable resolved plan and shall not retune, adapt, or silently fall back; an unavailable or rejected plan shall follow the selected failure/fallback policy before apply begins.
Learned	SCI-RTC-REQ-036	Restart shall restore a state-complete resolved plan, verify exact plan/input compatibility, and reject stale or incompatible beam, speed, scan, coefficient, rate, phase, role, or parent identity.
Response	SCI-RTC-REQ-037	The atomic bundle shall contain the complete realized response of SCI-RTC-DEF-010 or a typed unavailable state; a partial filter kernel shall not be labeled the conditioned response.
Response	SCI-RTC-REQ-038	Selection, detector mixing, time-varying calibration, masking, finite boundaries, state, or multirate behavior shall use a local/factorized detector-time response or truthful unavailability rather than an unjustified scalar transfer.
Response	SCI-RTC-REQ-039	A scalar LTI response shall be claimed only on a stated uniform, fixed-state, detector-separable, translation-invariant interior domain with no data-derived selector or undeclared rate change.
Response	SCI-RTC-REQ-040	Where defined, response shall distinguish amplitude, power, phase, group delay, sampling rate, Fourier convention, alias images, support, and response uncertainty; undefined phase/delay at a response zero shall remain unavailable.
Response	SCI-RTC-REQ-041	Output support shall be expanded transitively through alignment, replacement, every filter, state boundary, edge rule, and phase-zero selection; a selected center index shall not stand in for full support.

Area	ID	Normative statement
Statistics	SCI-RTC-REQ-042	Conditional mean and covariance shall follow equations (SCI-RTC-EQ-016a)–(SCI-RTC-EQ-016b) only for an admitted input model and fixed realized state, with reused donors and overlapping support represented as correlations.
Statistics	SCI-RTC-REQ-043	When selection depends on modeled random data, selection bias and selection covariance shall be modeled or explicitly unavailable; they shall not be set to zero merely by conditioning on the realized selector.
Statistics	SCI-RTC-REQ-044	Calibration, atmosphere, beam, donor-scale, coefficient, cadence/phase, response, and model nuisance terms shall retain value, validity, uncertainty, provenance, and correlation scope, including required cross terms.
Statistics	SCI-RTC-REQ-045	Unknown covariance shall remain unavailable and shall not be replaced by diagonal, white, stationary, independent, zero, or scalar-weight assumptions; conditional inverse variance shall not be called full precision or total uncertainty.
Validity	SCI-RTC-REQ-046	Acquisition support, original validity, ALIGN synthesis, numerical computability, coordinate validity, flags/causes, operator masks, replacement, transitive influence, complete support, response status, consumer eligibility, uncertainty availability, and provenance shall remain separate states.
Validity	SCI-RTC-REQ-047	A flag shall describe a cause and shall not automatically become a mask, invalidity, weight, or universal eligibility decision; aggregation shall preserve every contributing cause required by the selected policy.
Output	SCI-RTC-REQ-048	RTC shall produce the role-specific atomic bundle of equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-022); conditioned TOD alone shall not be reported as a complete required RTC product.
Output	SCI-RTC-REQ-049	Required malformed identity/state or missing authority shall propagate to atomic required-output failure; optional unavailable provenance detail shall be typed and numerically inert.
Output	SCI-RTC-REQ-050	Compact provenance shall reconstruct input/parent identity, detector binding, grid and intervals, calibration state, donor links, ordered filters, masks, coefficients/state/edges, sampling, response/uncertainty status, exceptions, counts, and all one-way state records.
Output	SCI-RTC-REQ-051	Each diagnostic shall name estimator, unit, support, mask/selection, validity, availability, and whether it is inert, advisory, or enters the selected policy; optional diagnostic detail shall not change values, flags, eligibility, cardinality, or failure.
Consumer	SCI-RTC-REQ-052	RTC shall supply cause-preserving validity inputs rather than a universal downstream eligibility bit; each consumer shall bind the exact RTC parent and shall not strengthen unavailable timing, coordinate, calibration, response, covariance, or eligibility claims.
Consumer	SCI-RTC-REQ-053	PTC-disabled terminal RTC output shall be a valid requested state when selected; no PTC or map product shall be implied, while any requested downstream product shall require the exact admitted RTC bundle.
Claims	SCI-RTC-REQ-054	Algebraic contract correctness, implementation conformity, representation fidelity, observational performance, science-impact qualification, and production readiness shall be stated and assessed as separate claims.

Area	ID	Normative statement
Lifecycle	SCI-RTC-REQ-055	Every learned operation shall name its learning population, estimator, support, selection, exclusions, quality, uncertainty, validity, and compatibility domain; same-observation learning shall be identified as data-dependent.
Lifecycle	SCI-RTC-REQ-056	Resolve shall convert evidence and fixed policy into one immutable plan containing every applicable sequence, family, coefficient identity, rate/convention, order/taps, band/notch parameter, applicability, mask, donor, edge/guard/reset, decimation/timing, response/support, uncertainty, validity, and downstream-compatibility field.
Lifecycle	SCI-RTC-REQ-057	A plan shall be resolved only when every required predicate and tolerance passes; missing evidence, missing tolerance, rejected evidence, or unavailable compatibility shall not be treated as pass.
Lifecycle	SCI-RTC-REQ-058	Any coefficient or operator parameter that evolves during apply shall be governed by a separately authorized online-adaptive estimator contract; it shall not be represented as learned-then-fixed filtering.
Design	SCI-RTC-REQ-059	Every despise, donor, mask, notch, low/high/band-pass, FIR, IIR, decimation, edge/state, or non-finite operation shall declare scientific purpose, signal/contaminant model, mathematical operator, design parameters, learn/resolve/apply behavior, astronomical and calibration consequences, validation/falsification, and unavailable states.
Design	SCI-RTC-REQ-060	Filter admission shall use the exact source-times-realized-response over the declared scan-speed/direction, projected-beam, source-class, prior-response, and cadence domain; $f \sim v/\theta$, a scalar FWHM, or a nominal cutoff shall remain pedagogical only.
Notch	SCI-RTC-REQ-061	Every notch shall resolve center, rate/frequency convention, width or Q, depth, family/order, poles/zeros where applicable, phase/group delay, state, transient/guard, applicability, learned uncertainty, drift tolerance, and combined response for overlaps.
Bands	SCI-RTC-REQ-062	Every admitted low-, high-, or band-pass shall resolve pass/transition/stop bands, ripple, attenuation, phase/delay, family, order/taps, precision, edges/guards, retained astronomical modes, and unavailable modes; no class label shall substitute for exact response.

Area	ID	Normative statement
FIR	SCI-RTC-REQ-063	FIR order or tap count shall follow owner-resolved transfer, alias, phase, support, guard, precision, and realizability constraints such as equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-025); an arbitrary integer or approximate family formula shall not be scientific authority.
Donor	SCI-RTC-REQ-064	Donor replacement shall be identified as a continuity surrogate at the target identity and shall separately establish numerical convention transfer, donor admissibility, and scientific eligibility; compatible <code>flxscale</code> shall not be evidence of common sky signal.
Donor	SCI-RTC-REQ-065	Beammap-role donor scaling shall use an explicitly identified prior APT or other pre-existing calibration authority and shall not use a new <code>flxscale</code> derived from the same Beammap conditioning lineage.
Sampling	SCI-RTC-REQ-066	Decimation factor and prefilter shall be justified from cadence, exact response, folded-band alias bounds, smallest projected crossing time, maximum valid scan speed, source class, timing/coordinate accuracy, and downstream compatibility.
Timing	SCI-RTC-REQ-067	Each plan shall resolve temporal registration through zero phase, shifted output time, coordinate correction, response-aware downstream use, or an approved bound on residual centroid/PSF effect; selected grid time alone shall not imply response centering.
CAL	SCI-RTC-REQ-068	Calibration transfer between Beammap and target processing shall bind the complete RTC plans and require matching response or explicit calculation, renormalization, or observational evidence; identical operation labels or preserved units are insufficient.
Validation	SCI-RTC-REQ-069	Validation of a notch, broad-band/FIR, donor, or decimation plan shall vary its scientific design parameters over the admitted scan/beam/source domain and measure astronomical transfer, phase/centroid, PSF/morphology, ringing, support/edge loss, covariance, and alias or interference residual as applicable.
Claims	SCI-RTC-REQ-070	No plan shall be called science-qualified solely because coefficient algebra, optimization, serialization, or deterministic operator fixtures pass.

Area	ID	Normative statement
Iteration	SCI-RTC-REQ-071	Iterative notch-plan refinement shall use a finite owner-approved cycle bound and stopping policy; an unbounded repeat-until-satisfactory process is unavailable.
Iteration	SCI-RTC-REQ-072	Within cycle k , apply shall consume exactly one immutable Π_k and shall not change coefficients, notch parameters, policy, masks, donor rules, decimation, or state conventions.
Plan	SCI-RTC-REQ-073	Every successor Π_k shall be a complete cumulative plan that dispositions all prior and proposed notches and records all stages, order, coefficients/precision, state, masks, edges/guards, intervals, decimation/timing, response/support, uncertainty, validity, and compatibility.
Replay	SCI-RTC-REQ-074	The default evaluation and final production rule shall apply each complete accepted plan to original admitted $x^{(0)}$ as in equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-029); exploratory cycles shall not accumulate hidden rounding, padding, state, duplicate-filter, mask, flag, or parent effects.
Cascade	SCI-RTC-REQ-075	A cascade from a preceding filtered product shall require explicit scientific-operator authority and immutable intermediate parents, with total response, state, phase, edges, support, covariance, uncertainty, and sequential parentage retained.
Evaluate	SCI-RTC-REQ-076	Each successor learn pass shall assess intended line attenuation and residual, parameter error/drift, predicted-versus-measured response, stability, ringing/transient, edge/guard loss, phase/delay, source amplitude/centroid/PSF, extended transfer, covariance, and support where applicable.

Area	ID	Normative statement
Candidate	SCI-RTC-REQ-077	A successor line shall be admitted only after comparison of original, predicted, and conditioned spectra, cumulative response, line uncertainty, astronomical spectrum, transfer/alias budgets, and detector/network/array/scan/interval consistency excludes notch-edge, ringing, transient, leakage, normalization, numerical, and response-floor artifacts.
Budget	SCI-RTC-REQ-078	Successor admission shall preserve owner-approved cumulative interference improvement, removed bandwidth, astronomical transfer, source amplitude/centroid/PSF, phase/registration, ringing/transient, guard/support, stability, cadence/response compatibility, uncertainty, and provenance budgets.
Stability	SCI-RTC-REQ-079	Plan stability shall compare the complete line set and matching identity, centers, widths/Q, depths, family/order, precision, applicability, state/reset, masks/guards, broad-band stages, decimation/timing, response/support, and compatibility over the required consecutive cycles.
Stop	SCI-RTC-REQ-080	Every refinement shall record one typed stop or continuation cause; maximum-cycle, oscillating-plan, and nonconvergent-parameter terminations shall not be labeled convergence or plan stability, and rejection shall leave the last accepted plan available unless policy says otherwise.
Lineage	SCI-RTC-REQ-081	Every cycle shall preserve index, original input, previous accepted plan, learning parent/population and PSD definition, original/predicted/measured spectra, candidates and dispositions, predicates/tolerances, complete resolved plan, evaluation product, cumulative response/astronomical diagnostics, stop cause, and final plan identity in one-way state.
Restart	SCI-RTC-REQ-082	Serialization and restart shall reproduce the final selected complete plan and declared parent rule exactly and reject incompatible original input, rate, learning population, parent, coefficient, interval, state, or policy identity.

F Falsifiable predictions and limiting cases

Each prediction is an algebraic or semantic falsification target. A future conformance activity may choose an exact numerical tolerance justified by the operation and representation before observing candidate output. No result is reported by this document.

ID	Construction and prediction	Falsifier
SCI-RTC-PRED-001	Identity chain: raw role, $A = I$, no replacement or filter, $M = 1$, valid original samples. Values, unit, order, identities, cardinality, response, flags, and support are unchanged.	Any hidden calibration, value/order/cardinality change, flag loss, nonidentity kernel, or new claim of timing/coordinate authority.
SCI-RTC-PRED-002	Role separation: feed the same dimensionless raw Beammap input to raw and explicitly CAL-authorized requests. The raw output remains $\Delta f/f$; the calibrated output exists only with its admitted CAL state.	A raw product labeled mJy/beam, a calibrated product produced without CAL authority, or silent interchange between the products.
SCI-RTC-PRED-003	Raw donor direction: choose $\phi_q = 2$, $\phi_d = 4$, and donor $x_q = 3$. Equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-002) predicts raw target replacement 1.5 and equal calibrated amplitudes 6.	Use of ϕ_d/ϕ_q , output other than 1.5, unequal calibrated amplitude, or dependence on legacy responsivity .
SCI-RTC-PRED-004	Raw donor availability: independently make either factor invalid, convention/domain-incompatible, occurrence-mismatched, or set $\phi_d = 0$. The <code>flxscale</code> route is unavailable.	Finite replacement, stale factor reuse, row-number-only binding, zero insertion, or success without separate donor authority.
SCI-RTC-PRED-005	Order: compare calibration-before-replacement with a proposed reversed affine path using unequal factors and nonzero offsets. Outputs and local response agree only if equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-004) holds completely.	Equality asserted from multiplicative factors alone, ignored offsets/uncertainty, or fixture equality labeled a general proof.
SCI-RTC-PRED-006	Interior target/donor impulses under fixed selection. Each output column equals equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-012); donor energy appears in the declared detector column, support, scale, and phase.	Missing or circularly wrapped energy, unexplained mixing, wrong donor identity/direction, support, normalization, or phase.
SCI-RTC-PRED-007	Constant input with sufficient context. Output equals the constant times realized DC gain after the declared transient; a DC-preserving chain is exactly constant.	Drift, divide-by-zero mask normalization, edge values advertised as interior, or a false DC-preservation claim.
SCI-RTC-PRED-008	Interior step with complete context. Response equals the cumulative impulse response and settles according to DC gain and stability.	Undeclared overshoot, failure to settle, hidden state leakage, or disagreement with the impulse-derived response.
SCI-RTC-PRED-009	Affine ramp through each FIR and admitted alignment mapping. Output slope and offset follow the zeroth and first moments of the exact kernel.	Unexplained clipping, wrong phase/slope/offset, or a ramp-preservation claim without the required moments.
SCI-RTC-PRED-010	Long bin-centered and off-bin sinusoids at DC, passband interior/edge, transition, stopband, and near output Nyquist. Amplitude and phase follow equations (SCI-RTC-EQ-013) and (SCI-RTC-EQ-014).	Gain/phase outside preregistered tolerance, unrecorded frequency convention, or an aliased component labeled passband signal.
SCI-RTC-PRED-011	Sinusoids at the realized notch center and symmetric offsets under the exact rate and state. Depth, width, phase, and transient follow realized zeros/poles.	Center/depth/width mismatch, unstable pole, rate mismatch, hidden state, or an edge transient reported ordinary-valid.
SCI-RTC-PRED-012	Coordinate mask with valid inside/outside values plus invalid, unavailable, wrong-frame, out-of-domain, and ambiguously bound coordinates. Invalid classes fail the affected operation and remain distinct from outside.	Invalid becoming outside/unmasked, entering geometry, clamping to a center/edge, or loss of the distinct cause.
SCI-RTC-PRED-013	Samples just inside, exactly on, and just outside each selected mask boundary and temporal dilation. Membership follows the recorded inclusive/exclusive and dilation policy identically across execution modes.	An undocumented boundary, frame mismatch, asymmetric dilation, or sequence-dependent membership.

ID	Construction and prediction	Falsifier
SCI-RTC-PRED-014	Impulses and constants at first/last support cells and immediately inside complete FIR context. Values, guard, support, and output admission follow the selected edge rule.	Undeclared padding, truncation, wrap, renormalization, guard, or output selection.
SCI-RTC-PRED-015	Zero, impulse, and constant inputs split and re-joined at scan/chunk/state boundaries for an IIR. Results follow the declared reset/carry and terminal-state policy.	Prior-observation leakage, hidden carry/reset, unbounded non-finite poisoning, or contradiction between split and declared state semantics.
SCI-RTC-PRED-016	Lengths $0, 1, L - 1, L, L + 1$ around every support/guard threshold, with stable scan identity.	Crash, underflow, stale output, silent scan deletion/renumbering, or ordinary-valid status without required context.
SCI-RTC-PRED-017	Inject NaN, $+\infty$, and $-\infty$ separately into a sample, factor, coordinate, coefficient, and IIR state. Failure or unavailable influence follows REQ-026 exactly.	Silent zero/coercion, finite-looking output without cause, stale state recovery, or an unbounded tail reported valid.
SCI-RTC-PRED-018	Place one typed cause at every member of a phase-zero output's full support, including a non-center synthesized or replaced cell. Each cause propagates and either such influence makes the output scientifically ineligible.	Center-only aggregation, erased cause, finite output called eligible, or replacement/synthesis treated as independent exposure.
SCI-RTC-PRED-019	For $M = 1, 2, 3, 4, 5$ and $N = 0$ through several incomplete final strides, enumerate $j = Mn$. Cardinality and selected time follow equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-011); no block mean appears.	Wrong N_y , dropped/duplicated point, nonzero phase, averaged value, timestamp misidentification, or rate mismatch.
SCI-RTC-PRED-020	Two sinusoids separated by an integer multiple of f_{out} , before and after the realized pre-filter. Folded amplitude is the sum in equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-014).	A folded term missing from response, inadequate stopband labeled alias-free, or incorrect image frequency/amplitude.
SCI-RTC-PRED-021	Reuse one donor for two targets and give neighboring outputs overlapping filter support. Equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-016b) predicts cross-target and temporal covariance when the admitted input covariance permits it.	Independent weights assigned, off-diagonal terms silently dropped, or reused donor described as additional exposure.
SCI-RTC-PRED-022	Enable a response-changing mask, donor mix, stateful filter, edge, and decimator while providing only a scalar FIR transfer. Complete response state is unavailable.	The partial scalar transfer labeled complete, or downstream use that assumes omitted stages are identity.
SCI-RTC-PRED-023	Learned candidates include at least two safe factors and one failing each astronomical-transfer, alias, sampling, realizability, and compatibility constraint. Equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-021) chooses the largest passing factor.	A smaller safe factor selected without rule, any failing factor applied, a percentile speed used for safety, or a missing numeric predicate treated as pass.
SCI-RTC-PRED-024	Serialize and restart a learned plan, then alter one of beam identity, speed support, scan set, coefficient precision, rate, phase, role, or parent. Apply rejects the mismatch.	Silent relearning, retuning, native fallback, stale-plan application, or realized state rewriting the request.
SCI-RTC-PRED-025	Execute two observations sequentially with distinct rates, constants, factors, masks, donors, states, and output parents.	Any coefficient, state, factor, donor, mask, rate, flag, or product link leaks from the first observation.
SCI-RTC-PRED-026	Toggle optional detailed provenance and inert diagnostics while holding the selected policy and realized operator fixed. Values, flags, influence, eligibility, cardinality, response, and failures are identical.	Any scientific or numerical result changes, or an observational/production claim appears from the toggle.

ID	Construction and prediction	Falsifier
SCI-RTC-PRED-027	Bind identical learned parameters first to a separate training population and then to the apply observation. The numerical fixed-state response can match, but the second plan records data dependence and parameter/selection uncertainty.	Same-observation learning represented as fixed a priori, or conditional linearity used to erase selection or parameter uncertainty.
SCI-RTC-PRED-028	Remove in turn one required learning-population identity, tolerance, uncertainty, or downstream-compatibility predicate before resolve. The dependent plan remains unresolved and apply does not begin.	Missing evidence treated as pass, a default inserted, or output represented as applied learned mode.
SCI-RTC-PRED-029	Serialize one resolved plan and attempt during apply to alter a notch center, cutoff, tap count, donor rule, or decimation factor. The mutation is rejected or belongs to a separately authorized adaptive estimator.	Hidden retuning, silent fallback, or a realized record that rewrites the resolved plan.
SCI-RTC-PRED-030	Sweep notch center error, line drift, width, depth, Q/order, initialization, direction, and overlap. Residual line and astronomical amplitude, phase, centroid, covariance, transient, and edge loss follow the exact combined response.	Only line disappearance measured, or any changed astronomical observable omitted from the plan's validity evidence.
SCI-RTC-PRED-031	Scan the same projected source at multiple speeds and directions through a fixed filter. Its temporal spectrum and retained amplitude/PSF change according to equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-023) and exact response.	One nominal cutoff or scalar beam treated as speed- and direction-independent proof of preservation.
SCI-RTC-PRED-032	Design FIR candidates over multiple tap counts and coefficient precisions. The selected N_* is the smallest candidate passing every registered transfer, alias, phase, support, guard, and realizability predicate.	Arbitrary configured taps, approximate order formula promoted to authority, or a candidate with any failed predicate selected.

ID	Construction and prediction	Falsifier
SCI-RTC-PRED-033	Inject compact and extended sources through admitted high- or band-pass candidates. Low-frequency rejection produces the predicted lost broad modes, compensated response, or negative lobes.	Unit preservation labeled flux preservation, or removed absolute/extended modes reported available without response restoration evidence.
SCI-RTC-PRED-034	Choose donor and target with compatible <code>flxscale</code> but deliberately different sky signal or beam coupling. Raw-domain convention transfer remains algebraically correct while the surrogate is not a missing-sky reconstruction.	Compatible factors claimed to prove physical donor equivalence or independent exposure.
SCI-RTC-PRED-035	Attempt Beammap donor scaling with a new <code>flxscale</code> derived from that same conditioned Beammap. The route is rejected until an identified prior factor authority is supplied.	Circular use of the new factor or absence of the prior authority in lineage.
SCI-RTC-PRED-036	Apply filters with known nonzero group delay to Pointing/Beammap scans in opposite directions. Centroid displacement follows equation (SCI-RTC-EQ-027) with opposite scan-direction sign unless time/coordinates are corrected.	Selected grid time treated as response center, wrong displacement sign, or unrecorded correction.
SCI-RTC-PRED-037	Process calibrator and target with plans that share a nominal label but differ in coefficients, rate, phase, state, edge, or decimation. Cross-plan calibration transfer is unavailable absent explicit response accounting or observational evidence.	Nominal label, preserved unit, or <code>flxscale</code> alone treated as RTC-plan compatibility.
SCI-RTC-PRED-038	Pass all deterministic coefficient and operator fixtures but withhold the required source/scan design studies. Algebraic correctness may be supported; science qualification remains unassessed.	Deterministic pass promoted to observational performance, science qualification, or production readiness.

ID	Construction and prediction	Falsifier
SCI-RTC-PRED-039	Inject one strong coherent line and no other valid line. Cycle 1 admits and suppresses it; Cycle 2 finds no successor that passes. The Cycle-1 plan remains final with a no-successor stop.	Unbounded iteration, an unsupported second notch, rejected evidence lost, or no typed stop/final-plan identity.
SCI-RTC-PRED-040	Inject two unequal coherent lines so the weaker becomes identifiable only after the stronger is suppressed. Cycle 2 resolves one complete two-notch plan and replays it once on $x^{(0)}$; output follows the predicted cumulative response.	Increment-only plan, final use of an accumulated exploratory product, missing first notch, duplicate filtering, or response disagreement.
SCI-RTC-PRED-041	Create a peak at a first-notch edge that agrees with predicted cumulative ringing or response artifact. The successor candidate is rejected and the first plan remains final.	Artifact admitted as a line, response floor ignored, or prior accepted plan invalidated solely by rejection.
SCI-RTC-PRED-042	Compare applying a one-notch plan twice with applying the intended complete successor plan once to $x^{(0)}$. Values, response, phase, edges, support, and covariance differ unless exact operator equivalence is proved.	Repeated filtering treated as replay, or equality claimed from nominal notch identity without complete operator proof.

ID	Construction and prediction	Falsifier
SCI-RTC-PRED-043	Propose a successor that fails one cumulative transfer, stability, support, or compatibility predicate. The rejected evidence and cause persist while the preceding accepted plan and its final product remain unchanged.	Failed plan applied, prior product rewritten, rejected proposal erased, or missing predicate treated as pass.
SCI-RTC-PRED-044	Alternate between adding and removing the same line or vary its parameters outside declared stability across cycles. Termination is typed oscillating or nonconvergent.	Alternation or parameter instability labeled convergence, stable plan, or successful maximum-safe refinement.
SCI-RTC-PRED-045	Supply a sequence that reaches the owner-approved maximum cycle count without satisfying plan stability. The result records maximum-cycle termination and the last accepted plan, not convergence.	Maximum count labeled stable/converged, continued iteration, or disappearance of the last accepted plan.
SCI-RTC-PRED-046	Serialize and restart the final cumulative plan, then vary original parent or learning-population identity. Exact compatible restart reproduces the product; either mismatch is rejected.	Silent relearning, stale-parent application, altered plan, or acceptance of incompatible learning lineage.

F.1 Analytic limits

The following limits are required: a compatible donor pair with $\phi_q = \phi_d$ gives unit raw donor scale; a replacement indicator tending to zero gives identity; filter coefficients tending to a Kronecker delta give identity; $M \rightarrow 1$ gives no rate change; a source-mask radius tending to zero selects only exact valid coincidences under the declared boundary; complete context approaches the declared interior response; and a causal pole approaching the unit circle exposes increasing memory and never retains a stability claim at or outside the circle.

End of shared normative core: SCI-RTC-v0.1/r0.3. View-specific material cannot add to or modify this scientific authority.